

2026 STANDARDS CHANGE FOR HEALTHCARE

Effective January 1, 2026 the following **healthcare standards** change:

- Protected income levels (PILs) for Medicaid for the Aged, Blind, and Disabled
- QMB, QI, and QDWI income maximums
- SLMB program is sunseting 1/1/2026 due to QMB program expansion
- SSI/AABD payment levels and federal SSI payment maximums
- MABD maximum allocation for ineligible child
- Substantial Gainful Activity (SGA) limit
- Pickle deduction percentage chart
 - NOTE: This document has been republished since 1/1/2026. All amounts are the same as previously published except for the maximum income amounts for households of one which are based on the Federal Poverty Level (FPL). These new income amounts, indicated by an asterisk (*) in the charts below, are effective 4/1/2026.

The following **Long-Term Care (LTC) Medicaid standards** change on January 1, 2026:

- Institutional income standard (IIS)
- Community spouse resource allocation maximum (CSRA)
- Substantial Home Equity limit
- Home upkeep deduction
- Allocations to community spouse- maximum, standard income allocation and shelter standard
- Allocation to each dependent family member living with a community spouse
- Community maintenance allowance (CMA) for the home-and-community-based waiver programs
- Medicare Part A co-payment for nursing home care

Eligibility maximums for Medicaid for the Aged, Blind and Disabled (MABD) and waiver programs, effective 4/1/26

Household Size										
Coverage Groups	Rule	% FPL	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
PIL outside Chittenden County	§ 29.14	N/A	1,375	1,375	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
PIL inside Chittenden County	§ 29.14	N/A	1,483	1,483	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
VPharm 1	§ 5441	150%	1,995*	2,707	3,419	4,132	4,844	5,557	6,269	6,982
VPharm 2	§ 5441	175%	2,328*	3,158	3,989	4,820	5,652	6,483	7,314	8,145
VPharm 3	§ 5441	225%	2,993*	4,060	5,129	6,197	7,266	8,335	9,404	10,472
Medicaid for working people with disabilities (MWPD)	§ 8.05d	250%	3,325*	4,511	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Healthy Vermonters (aged, disabled)	§ 5724	400%	5,320*	7,217	9,117	11,017	12,917	14,817	16,717	18,617

VPharm Ranges for premiums, effective 4/1/26

Coverage Groups	Rule	% FPL	Household Size							
			1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
VPharm 1 - VD, VG, VJ, VM \$15/person/month	§ 5441	> 0 ≤ 150%	1,995*	2,707	3,419	4,132	4,844	5,557	6,269	6,982
VPharm 2 - VE, VH, VK, VN \$20/person/month	§ 5441	> 150 ≤ 175%	2,328*	3,158	3,989	4,820	5,652	6,483	7,314	8,145
VPharm 3 - VF, VI, VL, VO \$50/person/month	§ 5441	> 175 ≤ 225%	2,993*	4,060	5,129	6,197	7,266	8,335	9,404	10,472

Eligibility maximums for Medicare savings programs, effective 4/1/26

Coverage Groups	Rule	% FPL	Household Size	
			1	2
Qualified Medicare Beneficiaries (QMB)*	§ 8.07b1	150%	1,995*	2,707
Qualified Disabled and Working Individuals (QDWI)	§ 8.07b4	200%	2,660*	3,609
Qualified Individuals - 1 (QI-1)	§ 8.07b3	202%	2,687*	3,645

*SLMB at 120% FPL has been subsumed into QMB

SSI/AABD payment levels

Living Arrangement		Effective 1/1/26	Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25
Independent Living	Individual	1049.68	1,022.68
	Couple	1596.80	1,555.80
Another's Household	Individual	704.72	686.72
	Couple	1,045.69	1,018.36
Residential Care Home w/ Assistive Community Care Level III	Individual	1,045.77	1,018.77
	Couple	1,594.54	1,553.54
Res. Care Home w/ Limited Nursing Care Level III	Individual	1,261.13	1,234.13
	Couple	2,094.69	2,053.69
Residential Care Home Level IV	Individual	1,233.62	1,206.62
	Couple	2,092.40	2,051.40
Custodial Care Family Home	Individual	1,099.60	1,072.60
	Couple	1,847.12	1,806.12
Long-term Care	Individual	79.93	79.93
	Couple	159.85	159.85

Institutional Income Standard for Long-Term Care (§ 29.14(f)(2))

<u>Effective 1/1/26</u>		<u>Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25</u>	
Individual	\$2,982	Individual	\$2,901
Couple	\$5,964	Couple	\$5,802

Personal Needs Allowance for Long-Term Care (§ 24.04(c))

<u>Effective</u>		<u>01/01/24</u>		<u>Effective</u>		<u>1/1/21 – 12/31/23</u>	
Individual		\$79.93		Individual		\$72.66	
Couple		\$159.85		Couple		\$145.33	

Substantial Gainful Activity (SGA) Income Limit (§ 3.00)

<u>Effective</u>		<u>1/1/26</u>		<u>Effective</u>		<u>1/1/25 – 12/31/25</u>	
Blind		\$2,830		Blind		\$2,700	
Disabled		\$1,690		Disabled		\$1,620	

Resource Maximums Household Maximums

MABD-related (§ 29.07)

<u>Group Size</u>	
1	\$2,000
2	\$3,000

Home-Based Long Term Care Disregard (§ 29.08(i)(12))

Note: See § 29.08(i)(12) for criteria that must be met in order to allow the home-based LTC disregard.

Effective 10/7/05
\$5,000

Community Spouse Resource Allocation Maximum, Long-Term Care (§ 29.10(e))

<u>Effective 1/1/26</u>	<u>Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25</u>
\$162,660	\$157,920

Substantial Home Equity Limit, Long-Term Care (§ 29.09(d), § 29.08(a)(1))

<u>Effective 1/1/26</u>	<u>Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25</u>
\$752,000	\$730,000

Resource Limit for Qualified Disabled Working Individual (§ 8.07(b)(4))Effective 1/1/18

Individual	\$4,000
Couple	\$6,000

Resource Limit for Medicaid for Working People with Disabilities (§ 8.05(d)(1)(ii))Effective 1/1/18

Individual	\$10,000
Couple	\$15,000

Other Standards**SSI Federal Benefit Payment Rate (§ 29.04, 29.14(b), 29.14(c))**

These are used when determining the eligibility of SSI-related adults, allocations to ineligible Children and parents, and the amount of income deemed to SSI-related child applicants.

Effective 1/1/26

Individual	\$994 per month
Couple	\$1,491 per month

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25

Individual	\$967 per month
Couple	\$1,450 per month

Maximum allocation for Ineligible child

Effective 1/1/26

\$497 per month

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25

\$483 per month

Business Expenses - Providing Room and/or Board § 29.15(a)(1)(iv)

Use either A or B below, whichever is the higher amount, for the business expense deduction:

A. Standard monthly deduction, as follows:

Room - Scaled according to the size of the group.

Board - Equal to the thrifty food plan allowance for the group size.

Effective 10/1/25

Use the below figures for any changes processed on or after 10/01/2025.

ACCESS Code	Group Size						
	Type	1	2	3	4	5	6+
1	Room Only	\$254	\$465	\$669	\$847	\$1008	\$1211
2	2/3 Board	\$199	\$364	\$523	\$663	\$789	\$947
3	Board Only	\$298	\$546	\$785	\$994	\$1183	\$1421
4	Room and 2/3 Board	\$453	\$829	\$1192	\$1510	\$1797	\$2158
5	Room and Board	\$552	\$1011	\$1454	\$1841	\$2191	\$2632

B. The actual documented amount of business expenses for room and/or board providing the amount does not exceed the income received from the roomers and boarders.

Business Expenses for Providing Childcare Meals and Snacks (Per Meal/Snack Per Day) § 29.15(a)(1)(ii)

Breakfast	\$1.70
Lunch Only	\$3.22
Dinner Only	\$3.22
Snack	\$0.96

Pickle Deduction Percentage Chart: § 8.05(h)Effective 1/1/26

4/77-6/77	0.8189	1/87-12/87	0.6572	1/97-12/97	0.5124	1/07-12/07	0.3730	1/17-12/17	0.2597
7/77-6/78	0.8082	1/88-12/88	0.6428	1/98-12/98	0.5022	1/08-12/08	0.3586	1/18-12/18	0.2449
7/78-6/79	0.7958	1/89-12/89	0.6285	1/99-12/99	0.4957	1/09-12/09	0.3214	1/19-12/19	0.2238
7/79-6/80	0.7755	1/90-12/90	0.6111	1/00-12/00	0.4836	1/10-12/10	0.3214	1/20-12/20	0.2114
7/80-6/81	0.7434	1/91-12/91	0.5901	1/01-12/01	0.4655	1/11-12/11	0.3214	1/21-12/21	0.2011
7/81-6/82	0.7147	1/92-12/92	0.5749	1/02-12/02	0.4516	1/12-12/12	0.2970	1/22-12/22	0.1540
7/82-12/83	0.6936	1/93-12/93	0.5621	1/03-12/03	0.4440	1/13-12/13	0.2850	1/23-12/23	0.0804
1/84-12/84	0.6829	1/94-12/94	0.5508	1/04-12/04	0.4323	1/14-12/14	0.2743	1/24-12/24	0.0510
1/85-12/85	0.6718	1/95-12/95	0.5382	1/05-12/05	0.4170	1/15-12-15	0.2620	1/25-12/25	0.0272
1/86-12/86	0.6616	1/96-12/96	0.5262	1/06-12/06	0.3931	1/16-12-16	0.2620		

Home Upkeep Deduction, Long-Term Care (§ 24.04(d))

Effective 1/1/26
\$787.26

1/1/25 – 12/31/25
\$767.01

Allocation to Community Spouse - Long-Term Care (§ 24.04(e)(1)(i))

- a. Maximum income allocation. If actual verified housing costs excluding fuel and utilities are greater than the base housing cost, allow up to the maximum allocation.

Effective 1/1/26
\$4,066.50

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/2
\$3,948.00

- b. Standard income allocation. (Maintenance income standard) This is 150 percent of the current poverty level for 2 people.

Effective 1/1/26
\$2,707

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25
\$2,644

- c. Shelter standard. This is 30 percent of the maintenance income standard in paragraph b, above.

Effective 1/1/26
\$813

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25
\$794

1. Fuel and utility standard.

Effective 10/1/25
\$1,096

Effective 10/1/24 – 9/30/25
\$1,067

2. Base housing cost
Effective 1/1/23
 \$0.00

Effective 1/1/06 – 12/31/22
 \$ 0.00

Allocation to Each Family Member Living with a Community Spouse - Long-Term Care (§ 24.04(e)(1)(ii))

This is the maximum allocation if family member has **no income**:

Effective 1/1/26
 \$902.33

Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25
 \$881.33

Allocation if family member **has income**:

Maintenance income standard
 - Gross income of family member
 Remainder

Remainder ÷ by 3 = Allocation

Community Maintenance Allowance in the Home-and-Community-Based Waiver Program (§ 24.04(c))

Effective 1/1/26
 \$1,483

Effective 1/1/25 - 12/31/25
 \$1,441

Medicare Copayments for Nursing Home Care

For the 21st through 100th day that a Medicare eligible person is in a nursing home, Medicare will pay the daily costs in excess of the following patient co-payment:

Effective 1/1/26
 \$217.00

Effective 1/1/25– 12/31/25
 \$209.50

Standard Deductions for Assistive Community Care Services (ACCS) (§ 30.06(c)(4)) and Personal Care Services (PCS) (§ 30.06(c)(3))

Assistive Community Care Services - ACCS

Effective 07/01/2026- 06/30/2027	Effective 07/01/2025- 06/30/2026	Effective 07/01/2024- 06/30/2025
\$89.93 per day	\$88.94 per day	\$87.20 per day
\$2,697.90 per month	\$2,668.20 per month	\$2,616 per month

Personal Care Services - PCS

Effective 07/01/2026- 06/30/2027	Effective 07/01/2025- 06/30/2026	Effective 07/01/2024- 06/30/2025
\$18.14 per hour	\$15.49 per hour	\$16.75 per hour

Average Cost to a Private Patient of Nursing Facility Services (§ 25.04(d))

This amount is used to calculate a penalty period for an individual in a nursing home or in the home and community-based waiver program.

Effective 10/1/25

\$12,535.13 per month

\$417.84 per day

10/1/24 – 9/30/25

\$11,032.52 per month

\$367.75 per day

SSI/AABD Payment Maximums (2700)

		Effective 1/1/26			Effective 1/1/25 – 12/31/25		
Living Arrangement		SSI Share	AABD Share	Total	SSI Share	AABD Share	Total
Independent Living	Individual	994.00	55.68	1,049.68	967.00	55.68	1,022.68
	Couple	1,491.00	105.80	1,596.80	1,450.00	105.80	1,555.80
Another's Household	Individual	662.67	42.05	704.72	644.67	42.05	686.72
	Couple	994.00	51.69	1,045.69	966.67	51.69	1,018.36
Residential Care Home w/ Assistive Community Care Level III	Individual	994.00	51.77	1,045.77	943.00	51.77	994.77
	Couple	1,491.00	103.54	1,594.54	1,450.00	96.77	1,553.34
Residential Care Home w/ Limited Nursing Care Level III	Individual	994.00	267.13	1,261.13	967.00	267.13	1,234.13
	Couple	1,491.00	603.69	2,094.69	1,450.00	603.69	2,053.69
Residential Care Home Level IV	Individual	994.00	239.62	1,233.62	967.00	239.62	1,206.62
	Couple	1,491.00	601.40	2,092.40	1,450.00	601.40	2,051.40
Custodial Care Family Home	Individual	994.00	105.60	1,099.60	967.00	105.60	1,072.60
	Couple	1,491.00	356.12	1,847.12	1,450.00	356.12	1,806.12
Long-term Care	Individual	30.00	49.93	79.93	30.00	49.93	79.93
	Couple	60.00	99.85	159.85	60.00	99.85	159.85